ACCESS RECOGNITION · STAFF HANDBOOK

Sending Thanks, the Access Way.

A quick, friendly guide to recognising your colleagues using the Access Recognition app — from your first login to sending your first card, and everything in between.

Version 1.0
For all Staff users · Access Group Australia

access.cgdev.site
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What's inside

This handbook walks you through everything a Staff team member can do inside Access Recognition — no jargon, just clear steps and screenshots you can follow along with.

1. Welcome to Access Recognition — what it is and why we built it
2. Signing in for the first time — email & password or Microsoft SSO
3. Your dashboard at a glance — the home screen tour
4. Sending a recognition card — the two-step flow
5. Your inbox — Received & Sent — the cards you've given and received
6. Opening a card — front, back, reactions, and comments
7. Notifications — never miss a thank-you
8. The leaderboard — see who's being celebrated this month
9. Your profile — avatar, preferences, password, and sign-in
10. Tips, FAQs & getting help

> **How to use this guide.** Read it cover-to-cover on day one, or jump straight to the section you need. Every page matches what you'll see in the app at access.cgdev.site.

Welcome to Access Recognition

Access Recognition is our internal thank-you app. Whenever a colleague does something that makes your day a bit better — big or small — you can send them a branded recognition card tied to one of our Access Group values.

What makes it special

IT'S PERSONAL

Every card is addressed to a specific person and explains exactly what they did. No generic "great job" — you say why.

IT'S ON-BRAND

Cards use the Access Group visual identity, so a thank-you feels like a real moment — not a throwaway chat message.

IT'S TIED TO VALUES

Each card calls out one or more of our five values, so recognition reinforces what we stand for as a team.

The Access Group values

You'll tick one or more of these every time you send a card. They're the "why" behind the recognition.

VALUE	VALUE	VALUE	VALUE	VALUE
People	**Safety**	**Respect**	**Communication**	**Continuous Improvement**

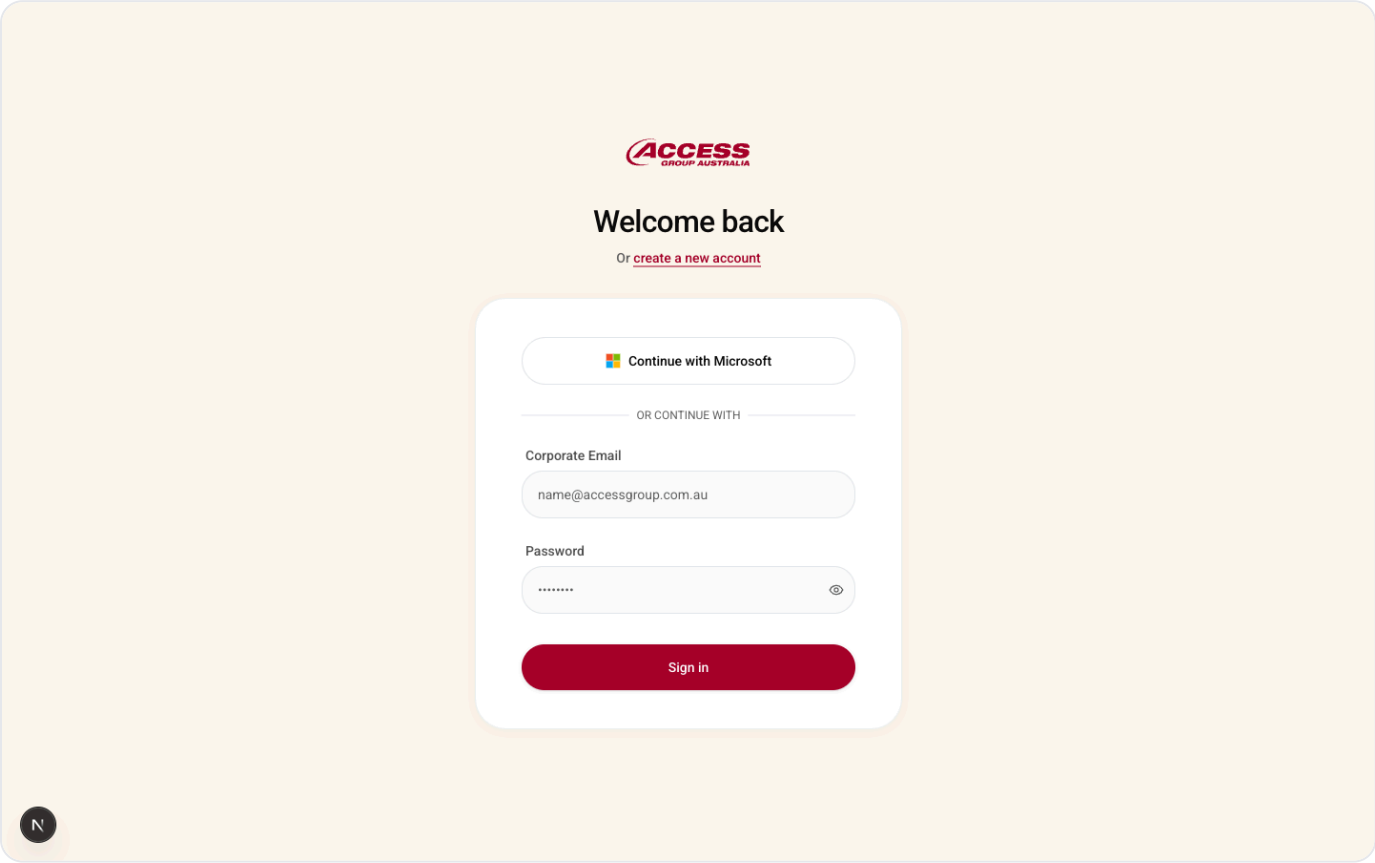
Who this guide is for

This handbook is written for team members with the STAFF role — that's the default for everyone at Access Group. Managers and administrators have a few extra tools (like staff directory management) that aren't covered here, since they're not available to you.

> **The golden rule.** You can't send a card to yourself — recognition only counts when it's given, not claimed. And please keep it genuine: one thoughtful card a month beats ten empty ones.

Signing in for the first time

There are two ways to get into Access Recognition. Most people use their Microsoft work account — that means no extra password to remember.



The login screen at access.cgdev.site — Microsoft SSO at the top, email & password below.

Option 1 — Continue with Microsoft (recommended)

1. **Open the app**
   Go to access.cgdev.site in your browser. Chrome, Edge, Safari, and Firefox all work.

2. **Click *Continue with Microsoft***
   You'll be sent to the familiar Microsoft sign-in page. Use your Access Group email and the password you already use for Outlook and Teams.

3. **Approve the sign-in prompt**
   If Microsoft sends you an authenticator notification, tap **Approve**. You'll be dropped straight onto your Access Recognition dashboard.

Option 2 — Email & password

If you've been set up with email-and-password access, enter your corporate email and password in the fields below the Microsoft button, then click **Sign in**.

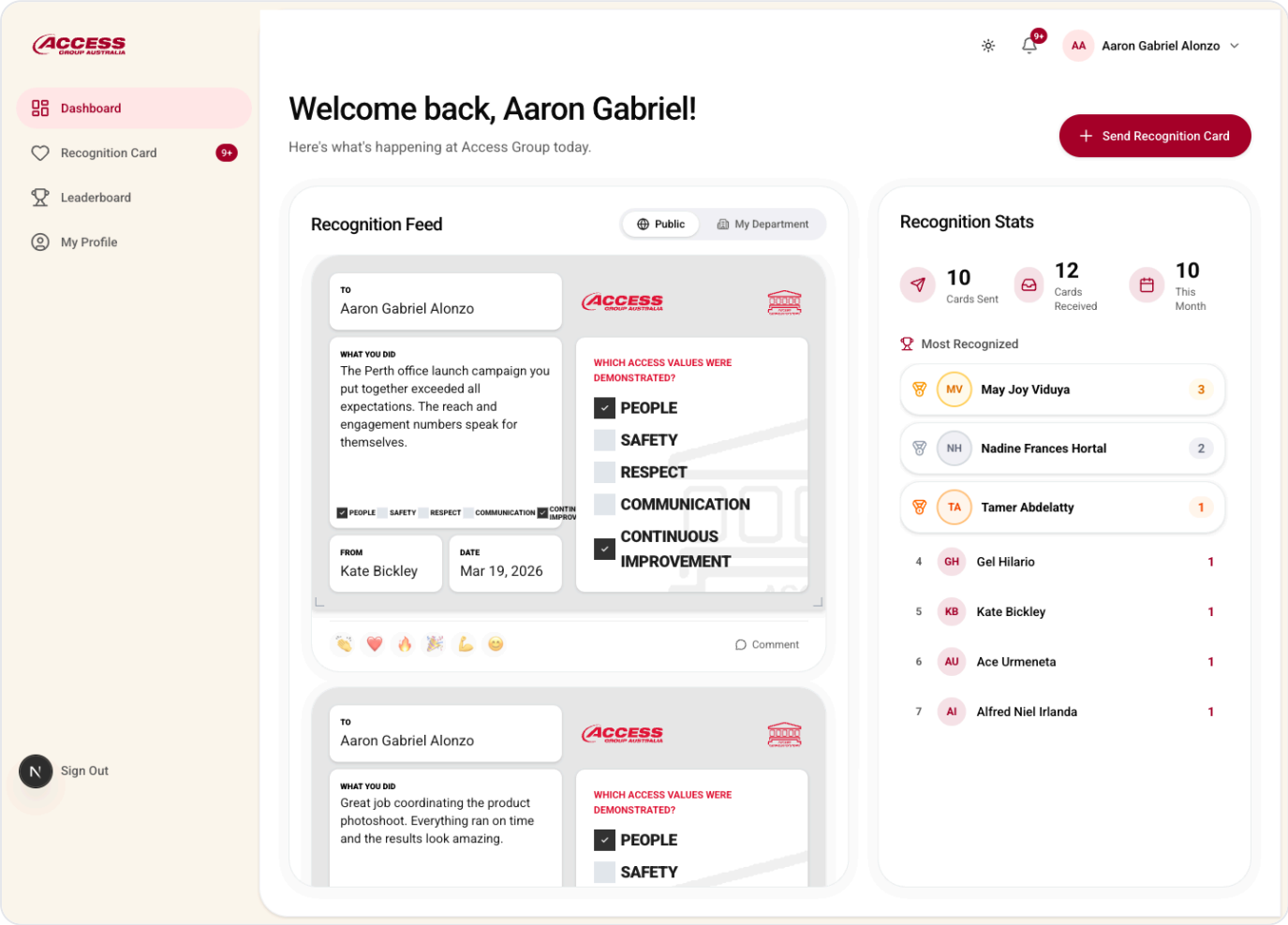
> **Can't sign in?** If you're brand new to Access Group and your account hasn't been created yet, give HR or your manager a heads-up — your account is added by an administrator, so it'll appear once you're onboarded in the system.

Signing out

To sign out, click the **Sign Out** button at the bottom of the left-hand sidebar on any dashboard screen. On a shared computer, always sign out before you leave.

Your dashboard at a glance

This is where you land every time you sign in — a bird's-eye view of what's happening across the team today.



Your home screen: sidebar navigation on the left, the recognition feed in the middle, and your personal stats on the right.

The sidebar

Four items, always visible on the left. Here's what each one opens:

Dashboard	The home screen you're on now — recognition feed + your stats.
Recognition Card	Your inbox of cards received and sent. The red badge shows unread received cards.
Leaderboard	See who's been recognised the most this month, across the whole company.

My Profile	Your avatar, preferences, password, and linked Microsoft/Google accounts.

The recognition feed

The big panel in the middle shows recent public cards. Two tabs let you switch between:

- **Public** — cards from everyone across Access Group.
- **My Department** — filtered to just your team.

You can react to any card in the feed with emojis, or tap **Comment** to leave a note. More on that in Section 6.

Your recognition stats

The right-hand panel is your personal scorecard:

CARDS SENT	CARDS RECEIVED	THIS MONTH
How many thank-you cards you've given since joining.	How many you've been given by teammates.	Combined sent + received activity in the current month.

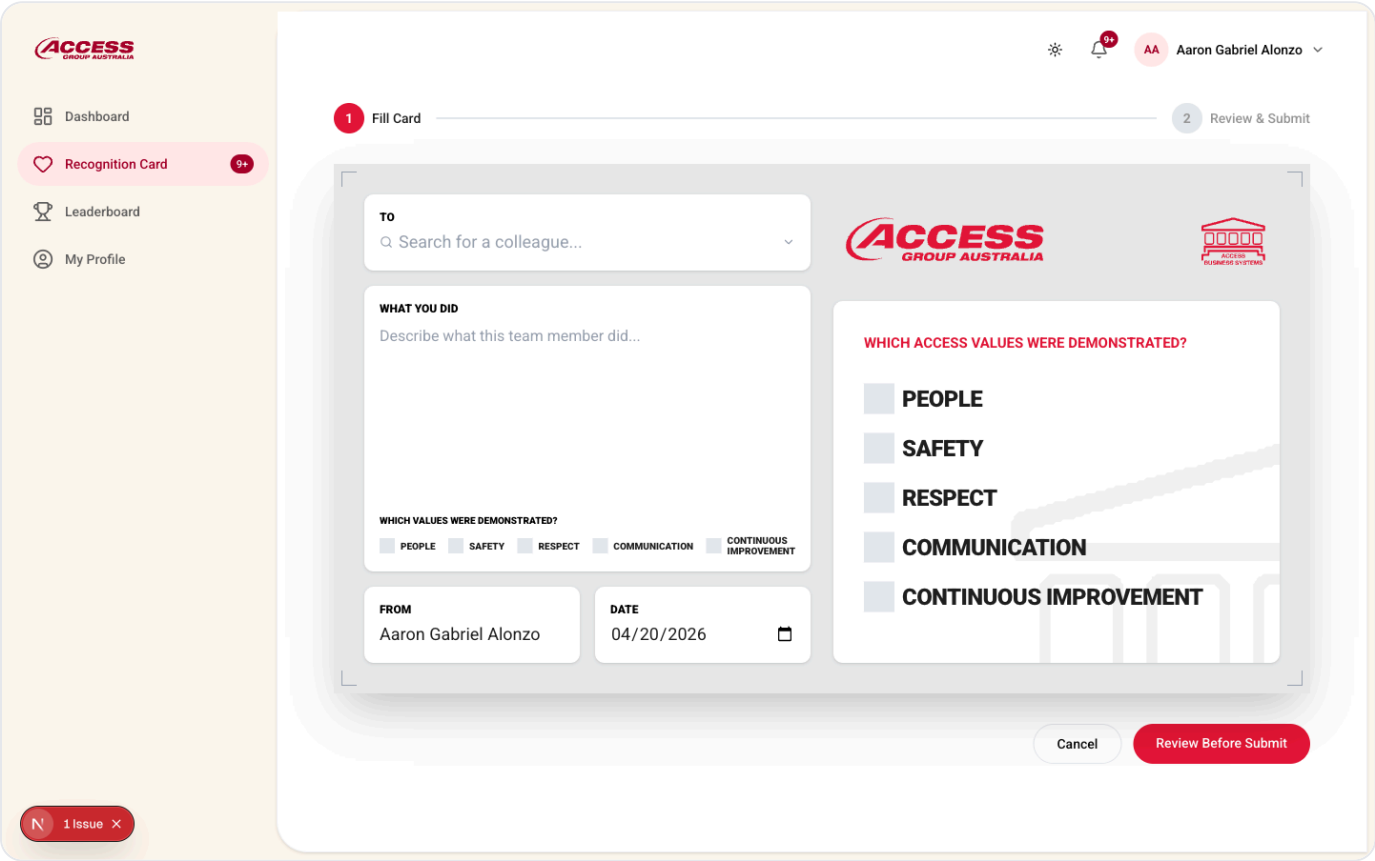
Below the stats is the **Most Recognized** mini-leaderboard — the top colleagues this month, with gold/silver/bronze medals for the top three.

> **See the big red button?** The *Send Recognition Card* button at the top-right is always one click away. Use it whenever someone deserves a shout-out — we'll walk through it next.

Sending a recognition card

Sending a card takes under a minute. There are two steps — **Fill Card** and **Review & Submit** — and the preview updates live as you type.

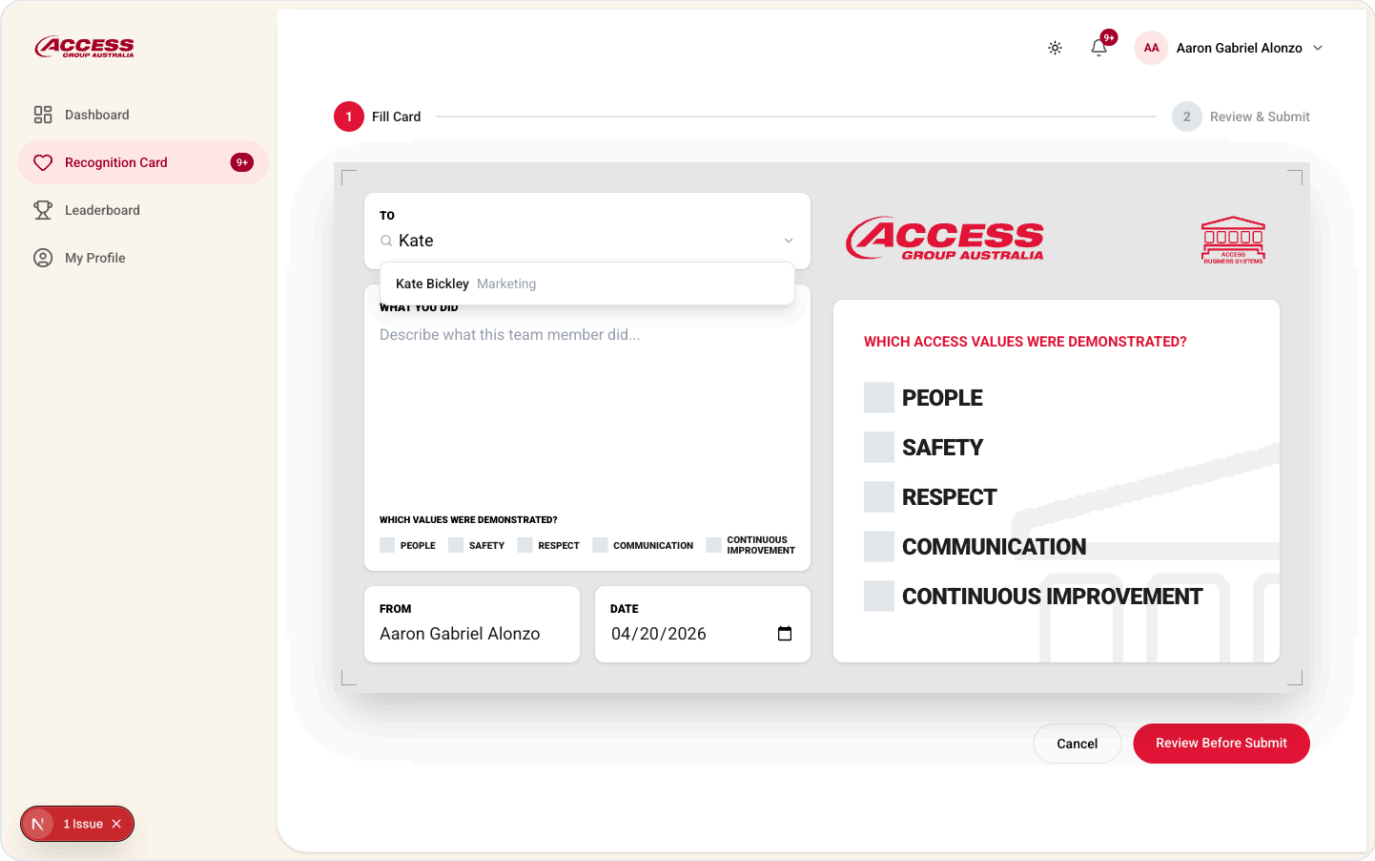
Step 1 — Fill Card



The card editor. The left side is your live card preview; the right side is the values checklist.

1 **Pick a colleague**

Click the **TO** field and start typing their name. Matches appear instantly.



Typing "Kate" surfaces Kate Bickley. Click the result to set her as the recipient.

2 **Write what they did**

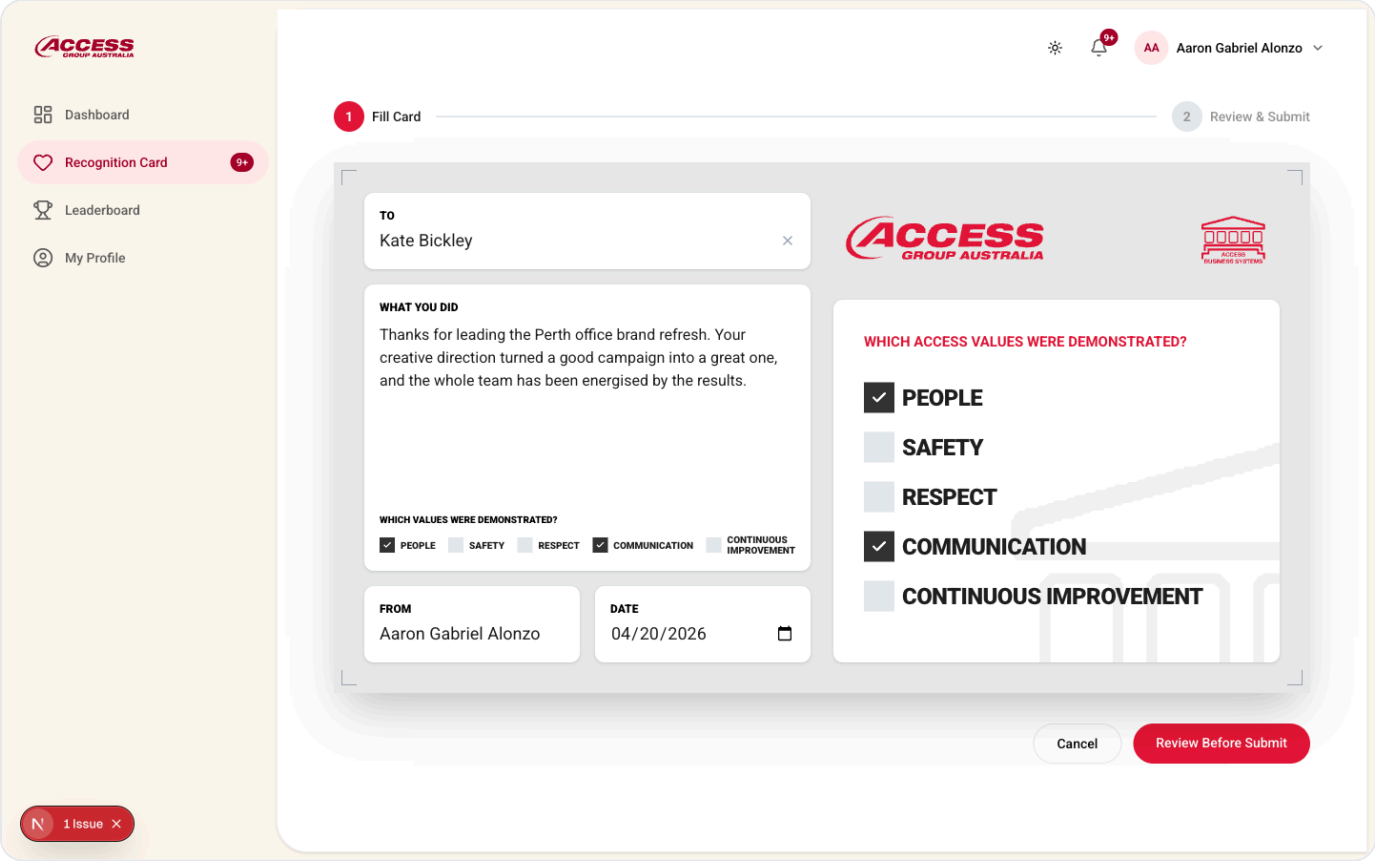
In the **WHAT YOU DID** box, describe the moment. Be specific — "stayed late to help debug the deploy" hits harder than "was awesome".

3 **Tick at least one value**

On the right, select every Access Group value the person demonstrated. You must pick at least one; multiple is fine.

4 **Check the date**

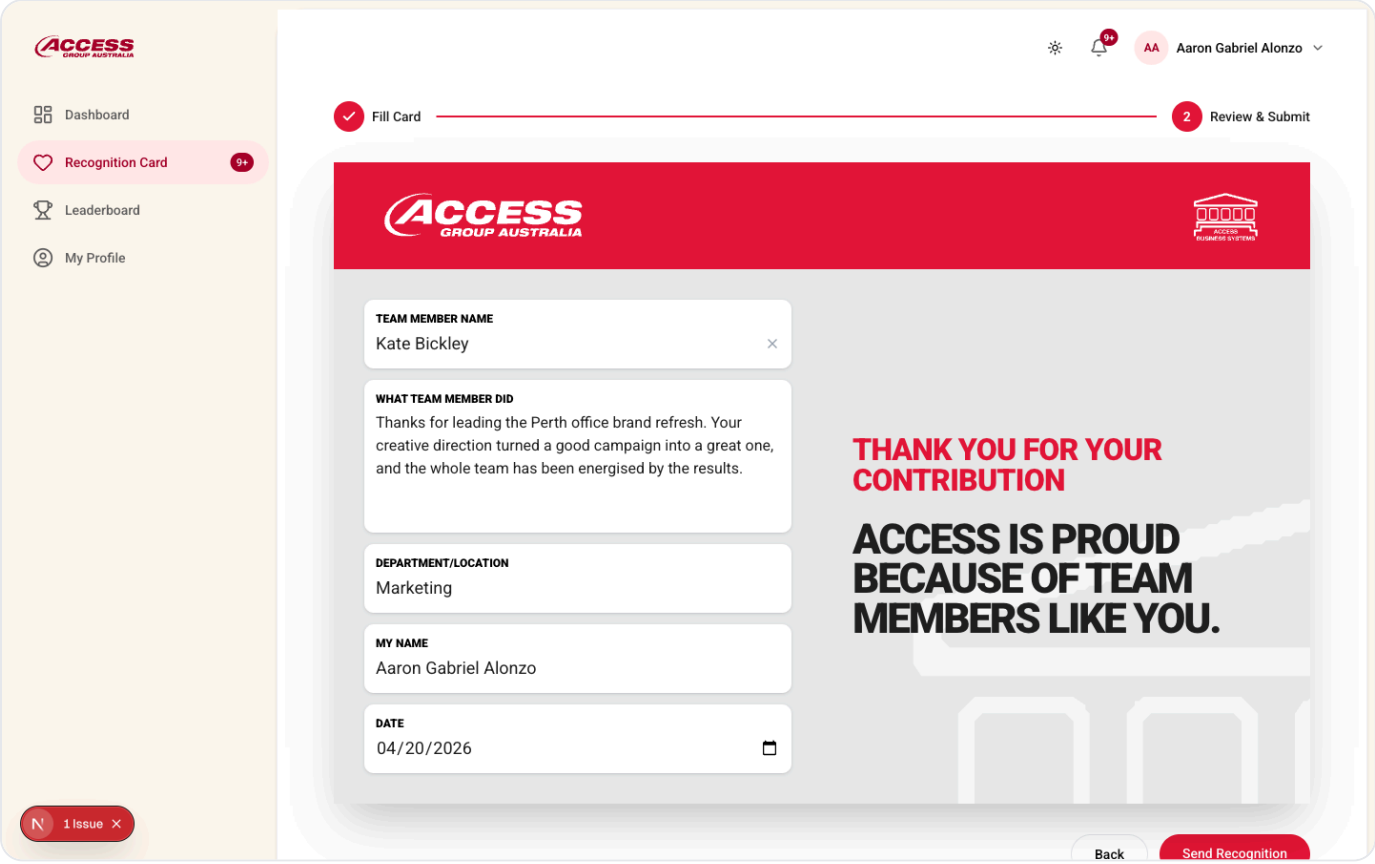
It defaults to today. Change it only if you're recognising something that happened earlier.



A completed step 1 — ready to review.

Step 2 — Review & Submit

Click **Review Before Submit**. The card flips to its final, on-brand look so you can double-check everything before it goes out.



The final card. Hit Send Recognition to deliver, or Back to tweak anything.

Once you send:

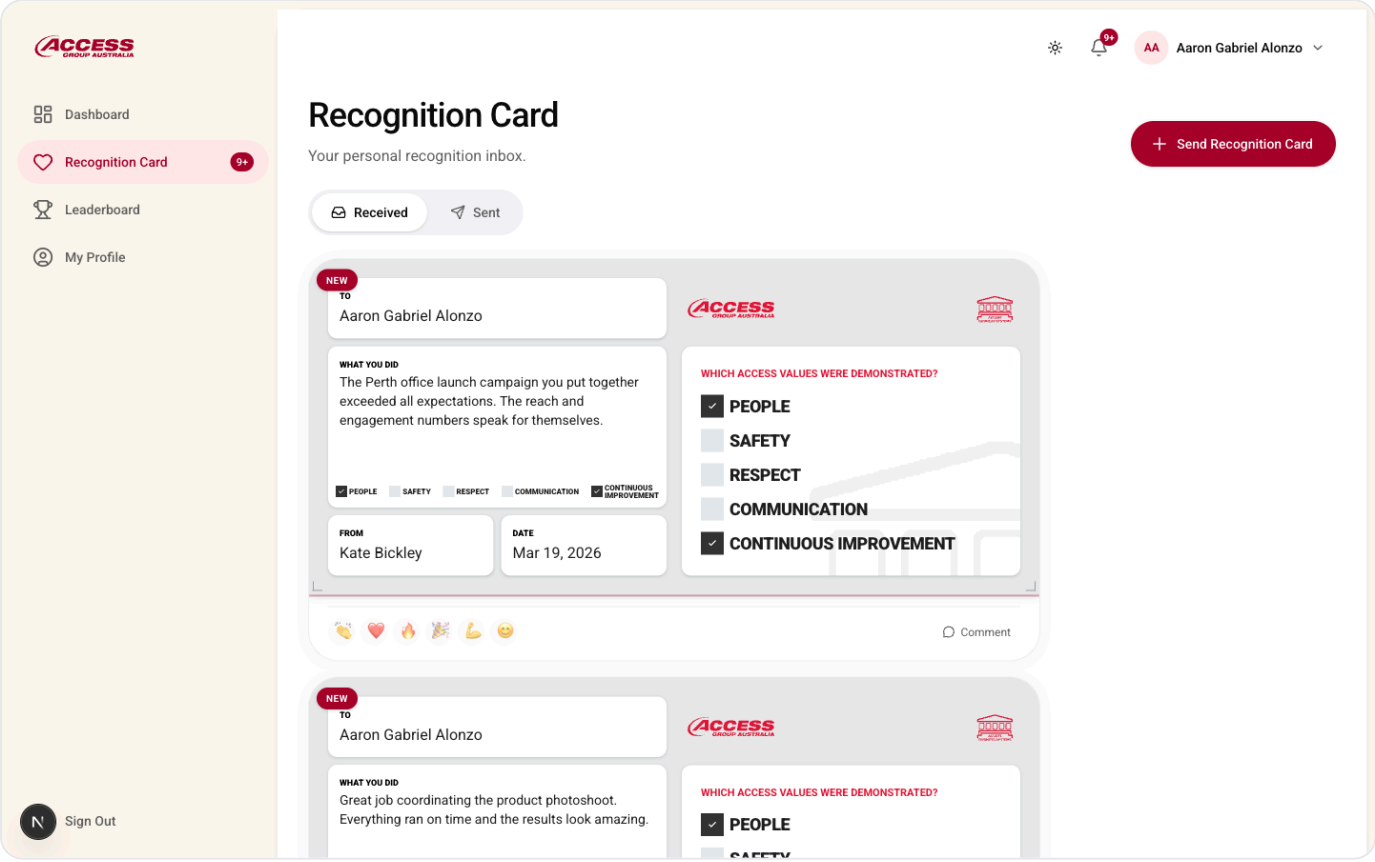
- The recipient gets a notification in their bell icon.
- The card appears in your **Sent** tab and their **Received** tab.
- If the card is public, it also shows up in the recognition feed.

> **You can edit your own cards.** If you spot a typo after sending, open the card from your Sent tab and click Edit. Recipients will see an "Edited" notification so they know you tidied it up.

Your inbox — Received & Sent

Click **Recognition Card** in the sidebar to open your personal inbox. Two tabs: cards you've been given, and cards you've sent.

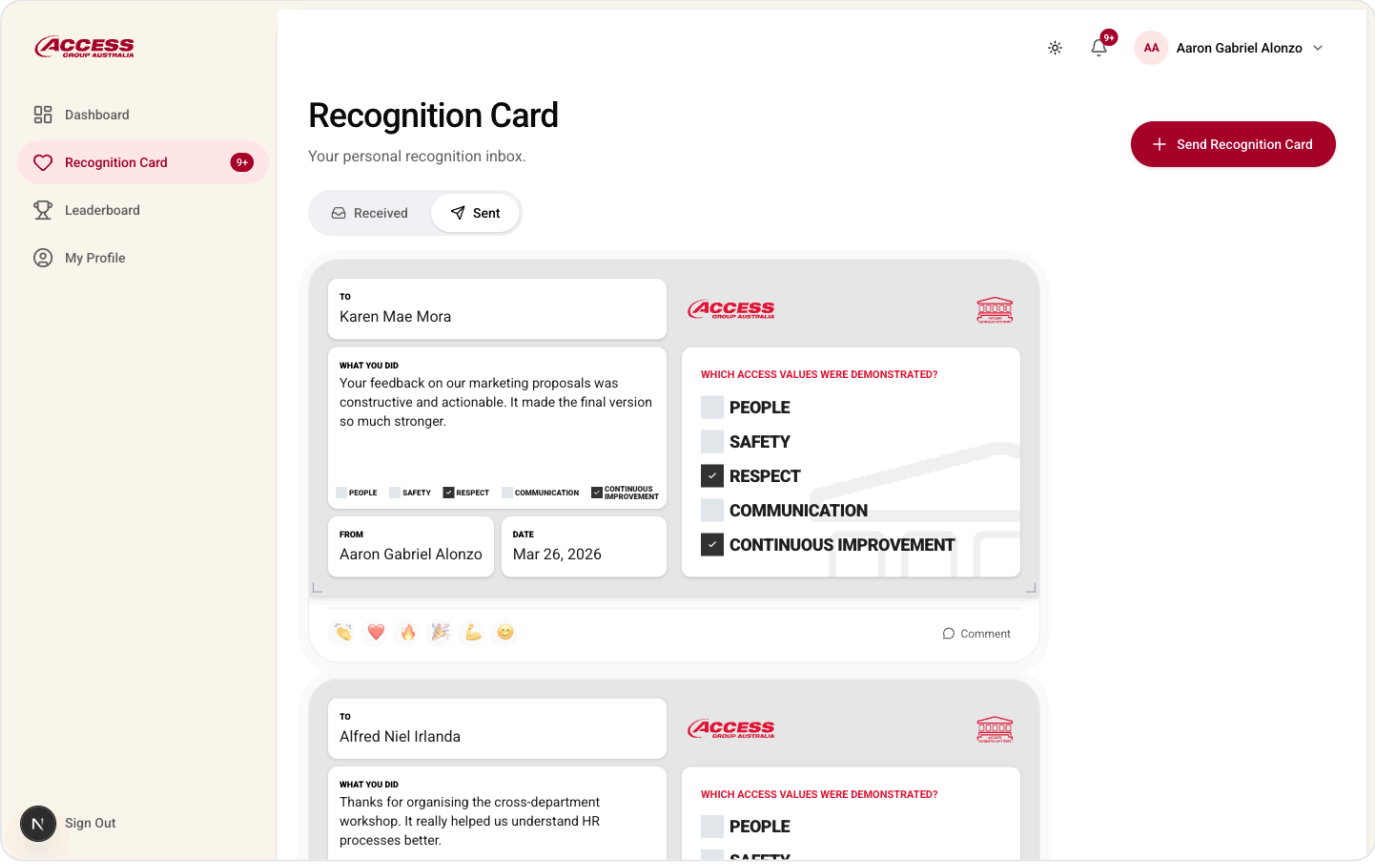
Received



The Received tab. New cards are flagged with a small red NEW ribbon.

Each row is a full, clickable recognition card. Click anywhere on the card to open it in full view, where you can see reactions and comments. See Section 6 for the full card view.

Sent



The Sent tab — everyone you've thanked, most recent first.

From the Sent view, you can:

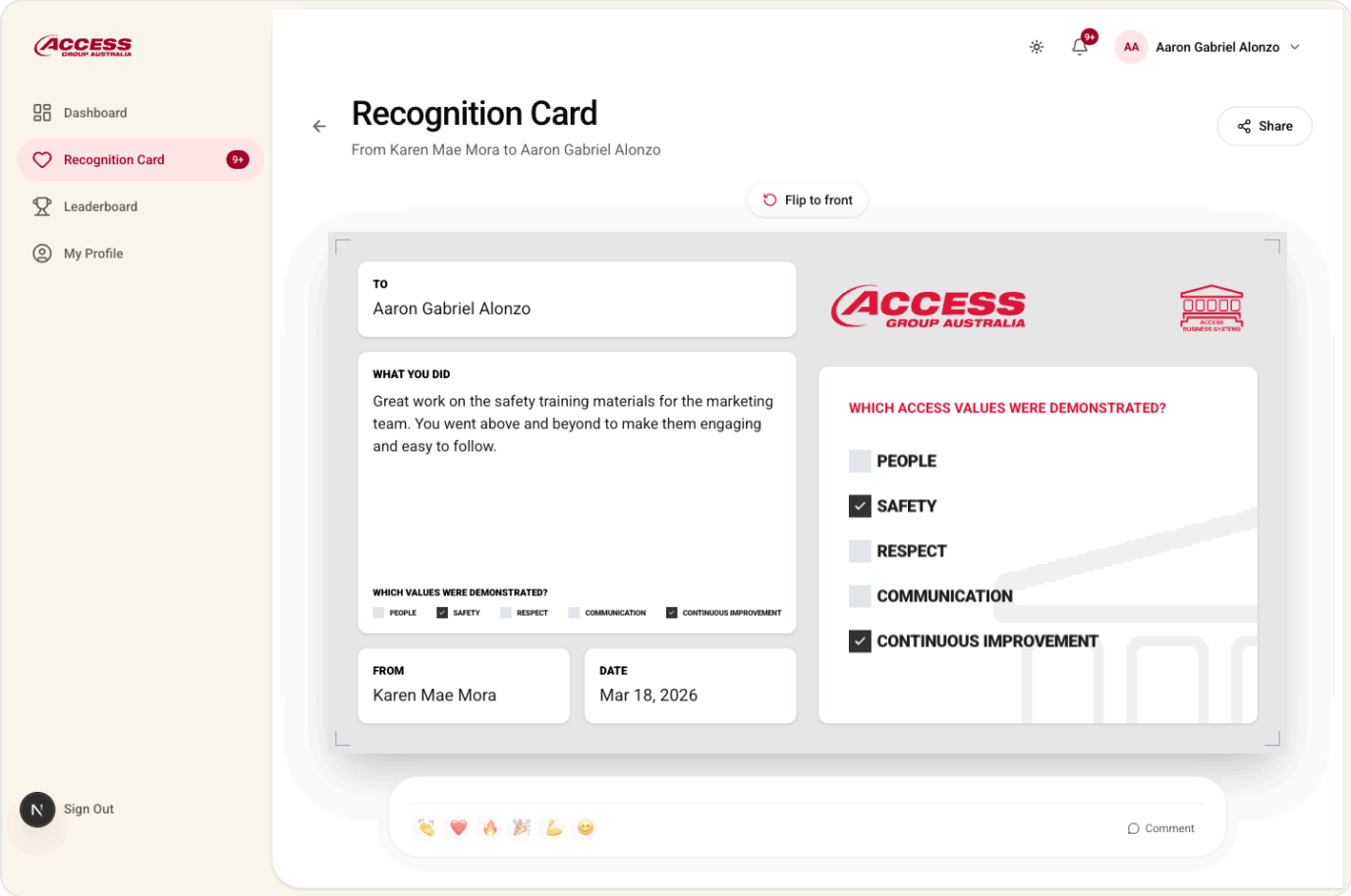
- Click any card to open and share it.
- Click **Edit** on a card you authored to fix the message or adjust the values.
- Leave the same card and come back later — the list is always fresh.

> **The red "9+" badge** next to *Recognition Card* in the sidebar is your unread counter. Once you've opened a card, it's marked as read and the number drops.

Opening a card

Clicking any card — in your inbox, in the public feed, or via a shared link — opens it in full. This is where the card really shines: reactions, comments, and the Access Group front-of-card design.

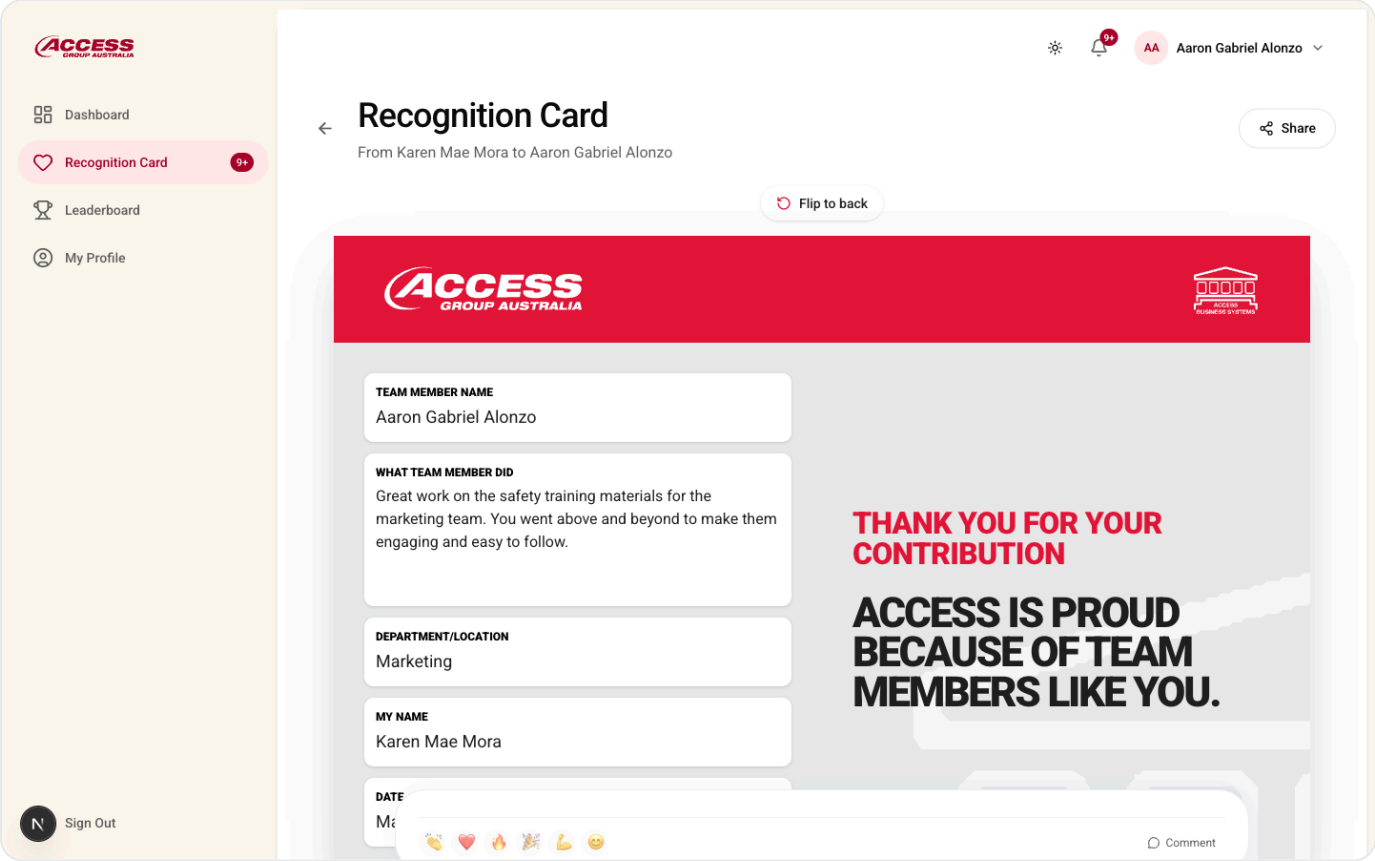
The front of the card



Who it's to, who it's from, what they did, which values they demonstrated.

Flip it over

The **Flip to front** / **Flip to back** button above the card shows the presentation-style reverse side.



The back of the card — perfect for a screenshot if you want to share a thank-you on Teams or LinkedIn.

React with an emoji

Below every card is a row of six emojis — 👏 ❤️ 🔥 🎉 💪 😊. Tap one to add your reaction, tap again to remove it. Reactions are visible to everyone.

Leave a comment

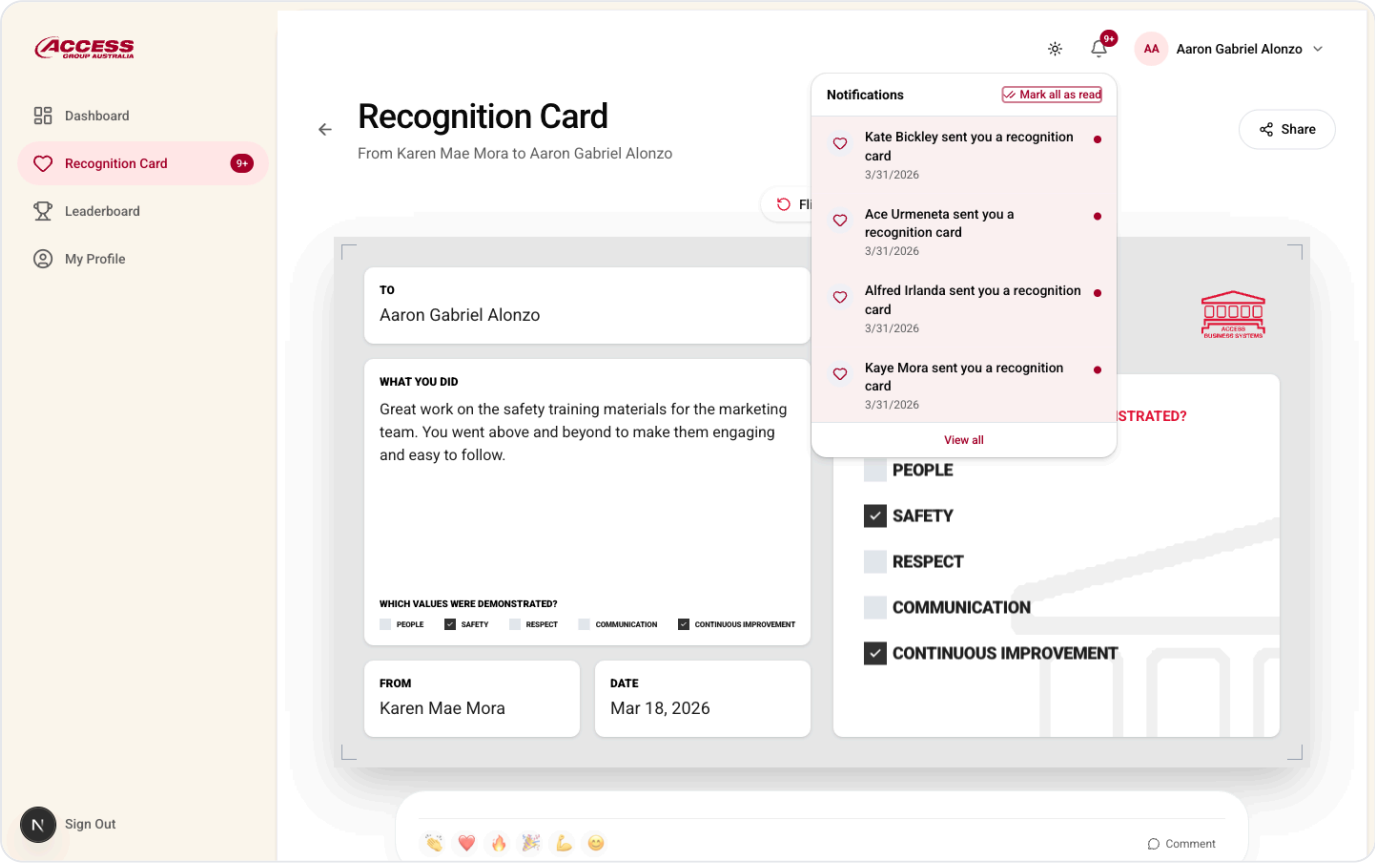
Click **Comment** on the right of the reaction bar to add a short note. Great for piling on a well-deserved thank-you, or sharing context the sender might not have known about.

Share a link

The **Share** button in the top-right of the card page copies a public link. Anyone at Access Group with the link can view the card — handy for Slack shout-outs or pinning in Teams channels.

Notifications

The bell icon in the top-right of every page holds your notifications. A red counter tells you how many you haven't read yet.



Click the bell for a dropdown of recent notifications, most recent first.

What you'll be notified about

- **Card received** — someone sent you a recognition card.
- **Card edited** — a sender updated a card you were given.
- **Card deleted** — a card addressed to you was removed.
- **Reaction** — someone reacted to a card you sent or received.
- **Comment** — someone commented on a card you sent or received.

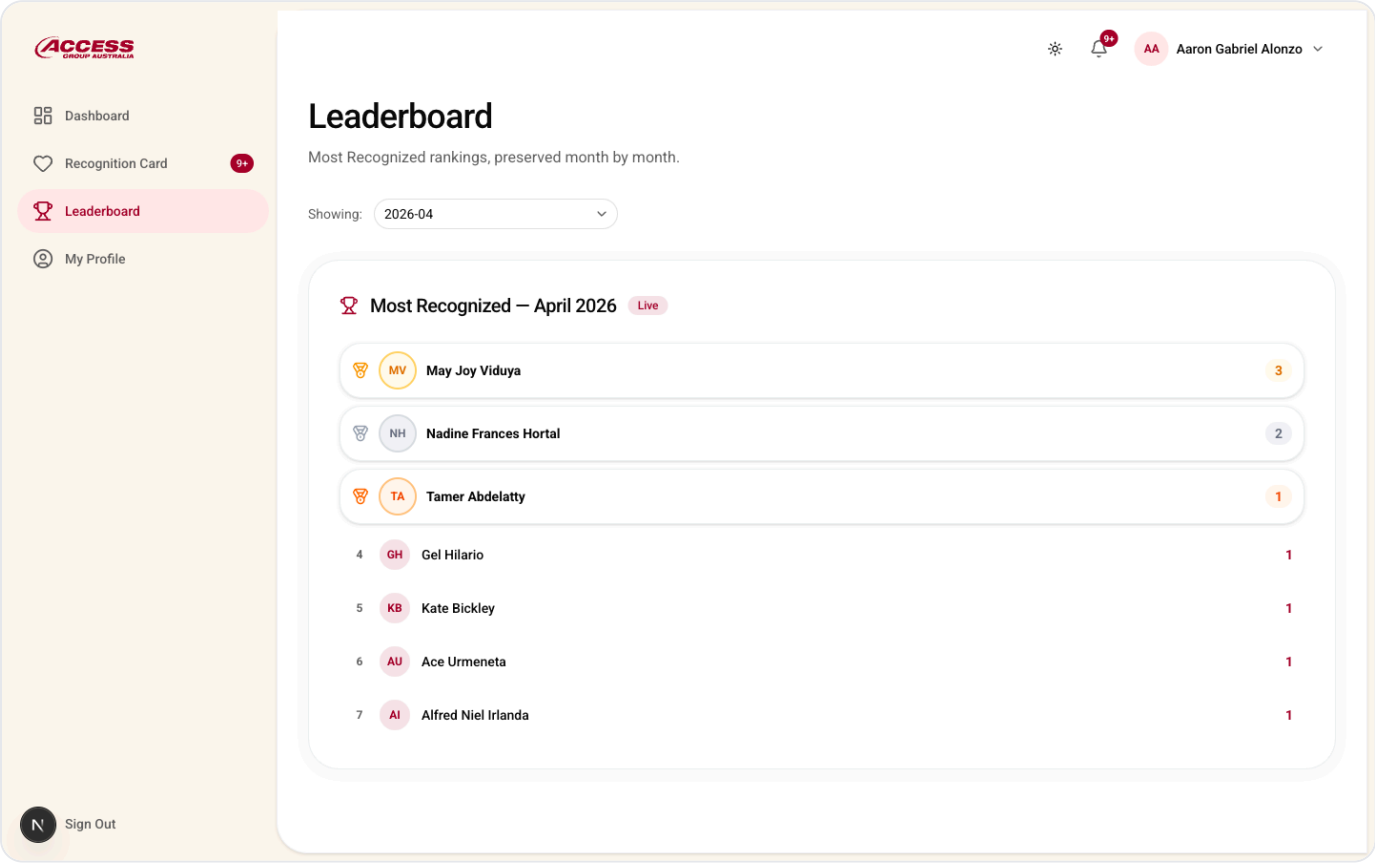
Clearing notifications

Click any notification to jump straight to the related card — that marks it read. Or click **Mark all as read** in the top-right of the dropdown to clear everything at once.

> **Tip.** Unread notifications don't expire. If you're on leave for a week, they'll all be waiting when you return — no catch-up email needed.

The leaderboard

The leaderboard shows the most recognised people at Access Group each month. It's fun, friendly, and deliberately celebratory — not a competition.



Gold, silver, and bronze medals mark the top three for the selected month.

How it works

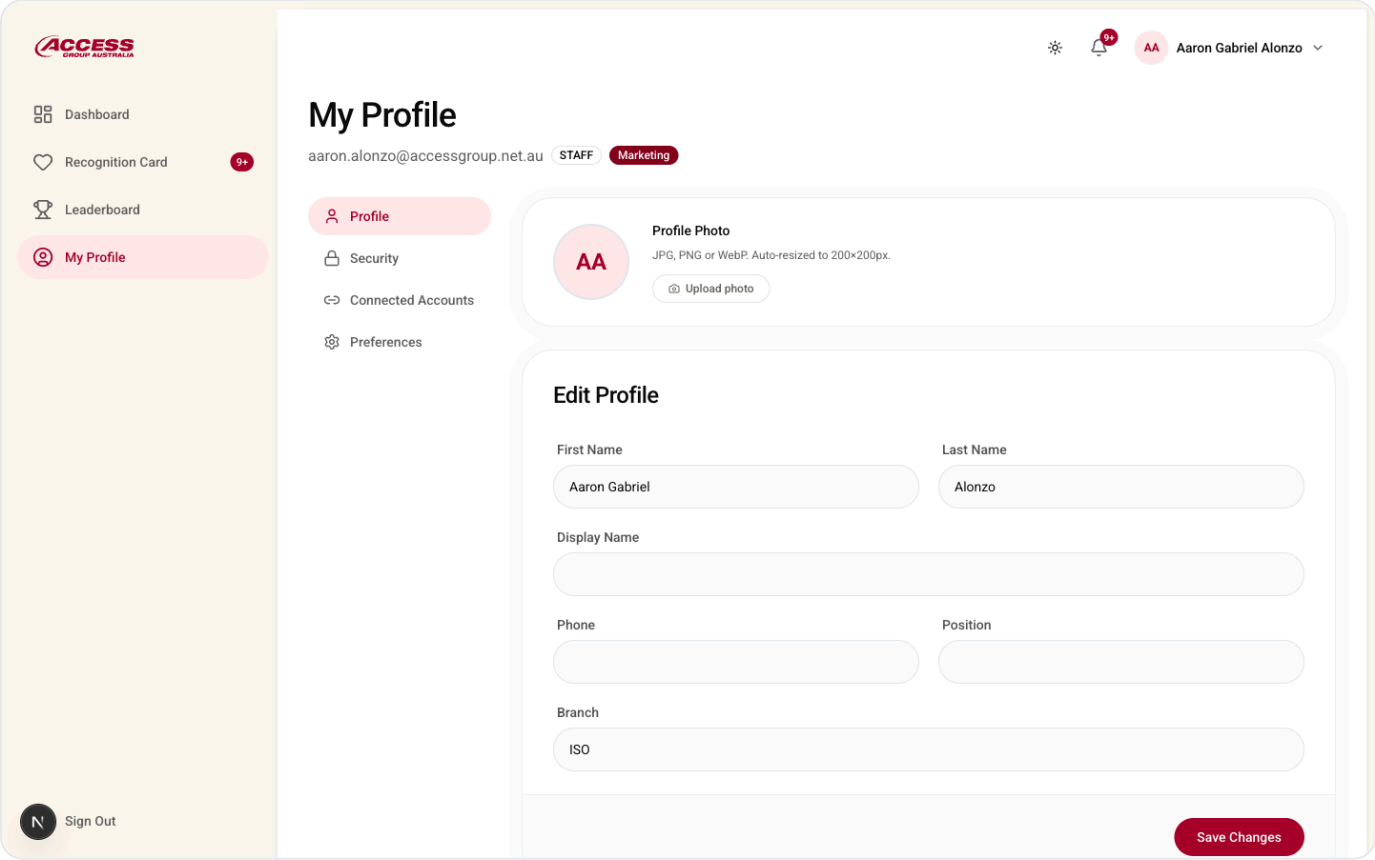
- The board counts cards **received** in the chosen month.
- Use the **Showing** dropdown to switch between the current month and past snapshots.
- The current month is labelled **Live** and updates in real time as cards are sent.
- Past months are frozen snapshots — great for looking back on who shone in, say, March.

> **Why it matters.** The leaderboard makes generosity visible. Sending more cards doesn't earn you a medal — but noticing great work around you does mean more colleagues feel seen.

Your profile

Open **My Profile** in the sidebar to update how you show up in the app. There are four tabs: Profile, Security, Connected Accounts, and Preferences.

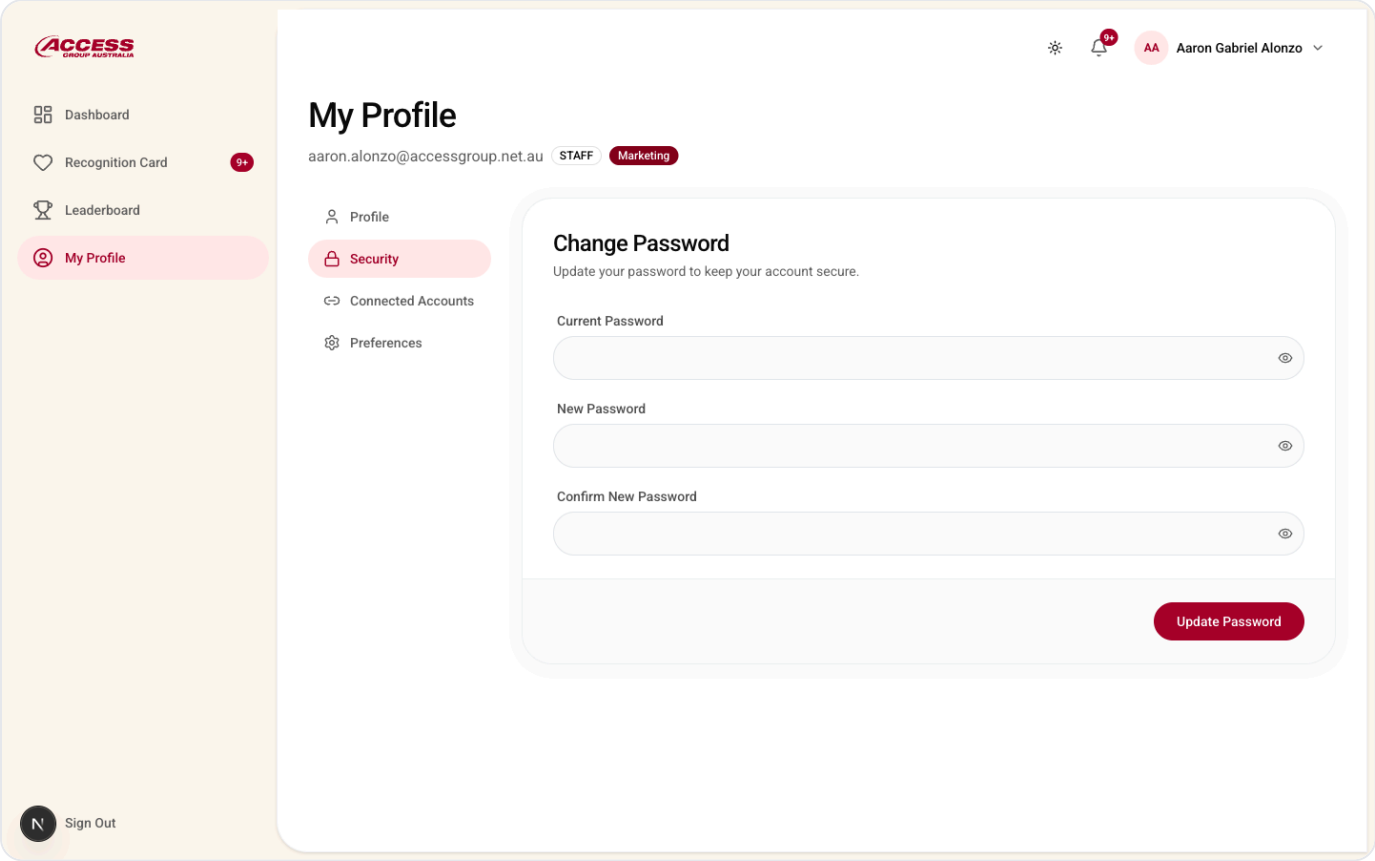
Profile



Upload a photo, set a display name, and fill in your role/phone so colleagues can find you faster.

- **Profile Photo** — click *Upload photo*. JPG, PNG, or WebP; the app auto-resizes to 200×200.
- **First / Last / Display Name** — display name is optional and shown when present.
- **Phone & Position** — visible on your profile card; useful for colleagues figuring out who does what.
- **Branch** — ISO or Perth, set by an admin when your account is created.

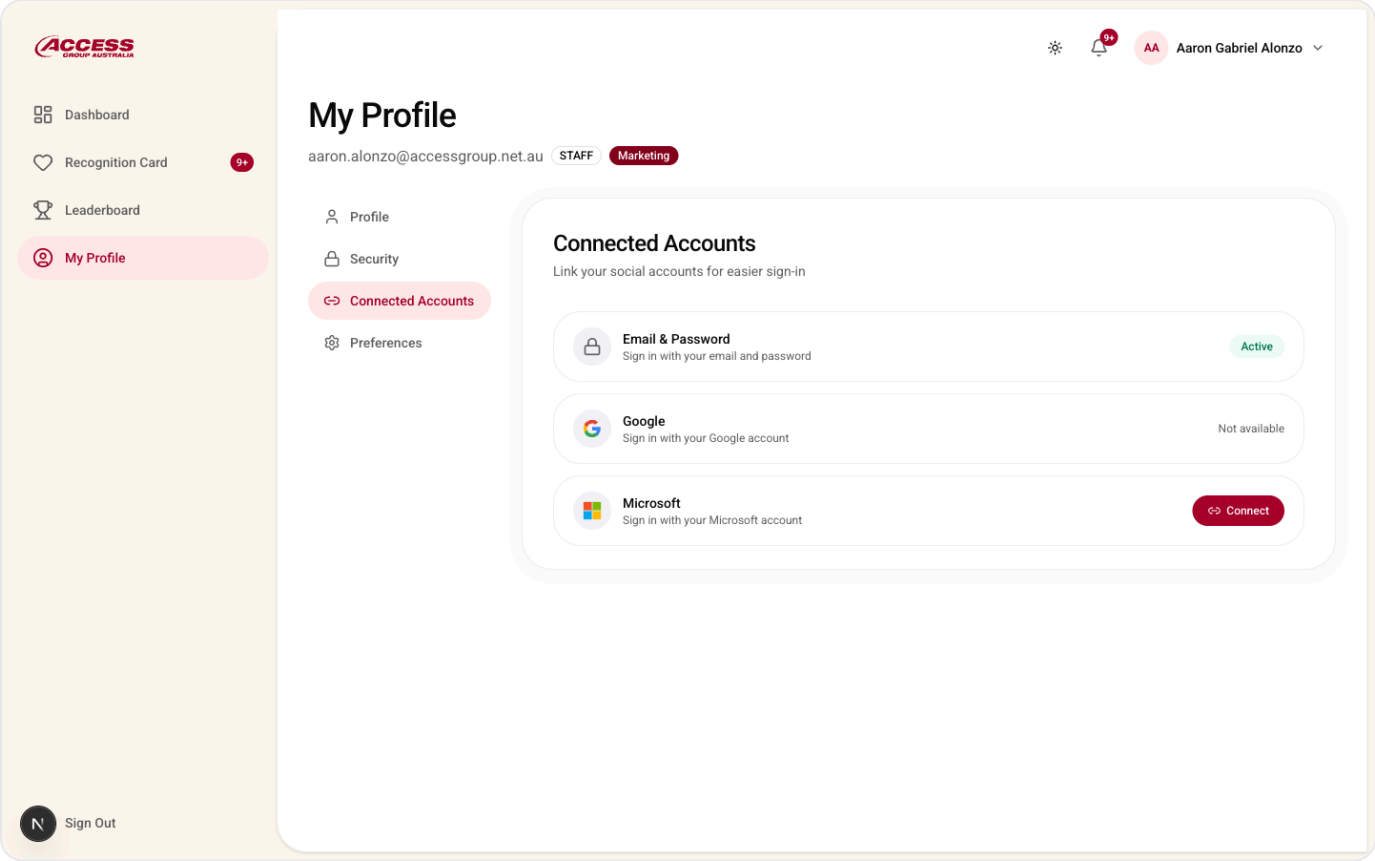
Security



Only shown if your account uses email-and-password sign-in. SSO-only accounts skip this.

To change your password, enter your current one, then the new password twice. Passwords must be reasonably strong — the form will tell you if it's too short.

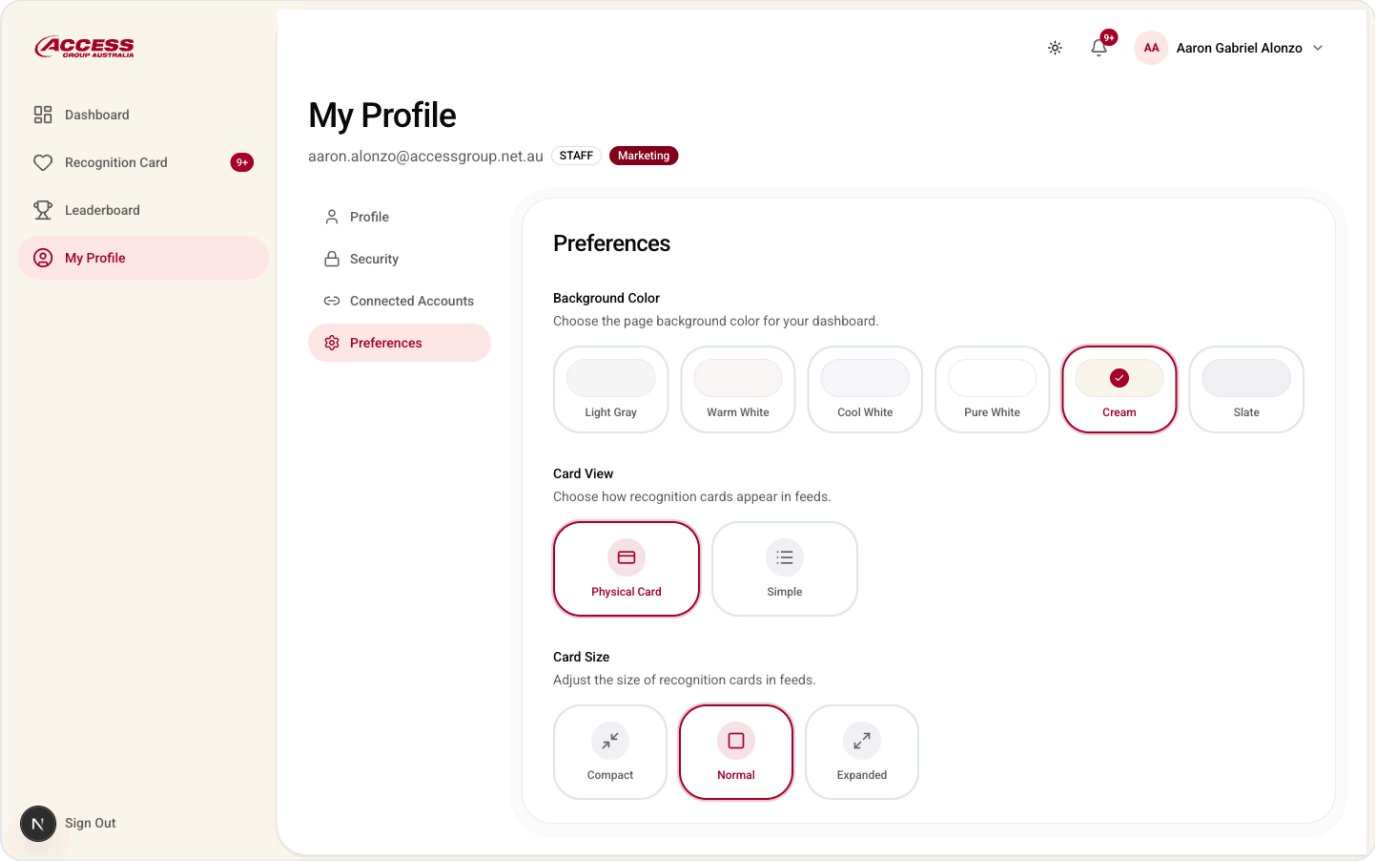
Connected Accounts



Link a Microsoft or Google account so you can one-click sign in next time.

Click **Connect** on a row to link that account. Once connected, you can sign in with either method. To unlink, click *Disconnect* on the same row.

Preferences



Purely cosmetic — changes only affect your own view of the app.

Background Colour	Six options for the page background. Cream is the Access default; try Slate if you prefer a cooler look.
Card View	*Physical Card* (full branded preview) or *Simple* (compact list). Pick whichever scans faster for you.
Card Size	Compact, Normal, or Expanded — changes how much vertical space each card takes in your inbox.

Tips, FAQs & getting help

A grab-bag of the questions Staff users ask most in their first month with Access Recognition.

Writing a great card

- **Be specific.** Name the project, the moment, the outcome. "Your push on Friday unblocked the whole pipeline" beats "great job".
- **Pick values on purpose.** Ticking all five dilutes the meaning. Choose the one or two that really applied.
- **Recognise people outside your team.** Cross-department thanks tend to mean the most — they're less expected.
- **Keep it authentic.** A short, honest card beats a long, generic one every time.

Frequently asked questions

Can I send a card to myself?

No — the recipient picker won't let you pick yourself, and the app rejects the submission server-side if you try to sneak past the UI.

Can I delete a card I sent?

Yes. Open the card from your Sent tab and choose Delete. The recipient gets a small "card deleted" notification. Only the sender can delete.

Who can see my cards?

Your received and sent cards are visible to everyone at Access Group through the public feed and the card detail page, unless marked otherwise. This is by design — recognition is meant to be seen.

Do I get an email when I receive a card?

Not in v1 of the app — notifications live inside the bell icon. Email alerts are on the roadmap.

Something looks wrong / I can't sign in.

Try a refresh first. If that doesn't help, ping the HR team or the app's administrators — they have tools to reset accounts, restore deleted users, and investigate edge cases.

Where to find help

APP URL

access.cgdev.site — bookmark it. Works on desktop and mobile.

ADMINS

Your HR team and department admins can reset your password, update your branch/department, or link your Microsoft account.

One last thing. This app only works if people use it. Every card you send makes someone's day, and a thriving culture of recognition starts with one person choosing to say thanks. That person might as well be you.